

OBJECTIVES

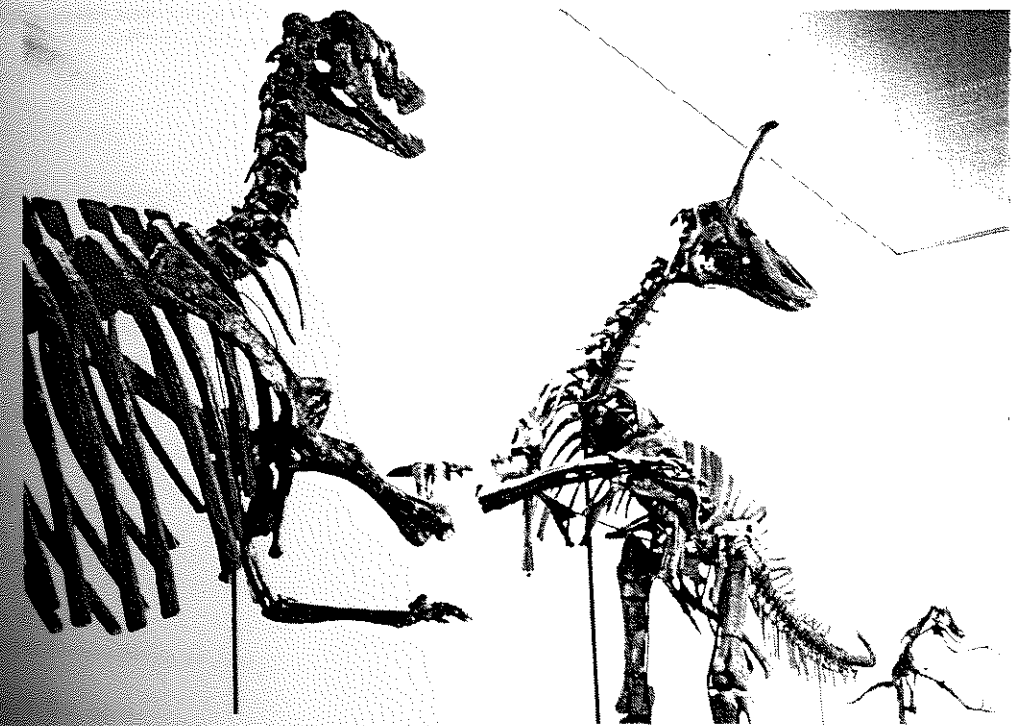
The aim of the Queen Victoria Museum and Art Gallery is to increase and disseminate knowledge about our natural and cultural heritage with particular reference to Tasmania. The development and maintenance of the Museum's existing rich and diverse collections are fundamental to the achievement of this aim.

In accomplishing this, the Museum is actively:

- involved in research, exhibition and education programmes both within and beyond Tasmania.
- improving community access to the institution, its facilities and collections.
- improving the contribution it makes to the cultural well-being of the community.

HIGHLIGHTS

- * The decision by the Government of Tasmania to increase the funding of the institution's core budget from 50% to 62.5%.
- * The opening of the Launceston Science Centre, a branch of the Museum, sponsored by BP (Australia) Pty Ltd, as a Bicentennial project.
- * The opening of *Designers* coffee shop as a result of widespread community support.
- * The donation of the P. L. Brown collection of ethnographic and historical material collected by George Augustus Robinson.
- * The acquisition and installation of computer facilities with sophisticated data retrieval capabilities that will enable access to all specimen information.
- * The continued increase in participation in Museum programmes with attendance increasing by over 9%.
- * The outstanding success of the exhibitions *Dinosaurs* and *Tasmanian Vision*.
- * The establishment of a Volunteer Guide Programme for the art gallery.
- * The successful tour of the *Australian Vertebrate Fossils* exhibition to North America.
- * The contributions of the Launceston Art Foundation and Plomley Foundation.



The *Dinosaurs* exhibition attracted more than 58,106 visitors of which 10,000 were school children from throughout the state and the Bass Strait islands.

by the Premier of Tasmania, the Hon. R. T. Gray, this exhibition was funded by the Municipality of Ross.

A small exhibition was also prepared to complement the *Westpac National Travelling Exhibition* while it was in Launceston.

DINOSAURS

One of the most successful of all Museum exhibitions, the planning for *Dinosaurs* commenced two years ago. In early 1987 a number of specimens from the Museum's collection were made available to the Museum of Victoria for their exhibition *Esso' Return of the Dinosaurs*. In addition an articulated skeleton and life size model of the dinosaur *Hypsilophodon* were produced for this exhibition in Melbourne.

The exhibition was presented in Auckland, New Zealand, before coming to Launceston. A considerable number of specimens and reconstructions were added to the already impressive exhibition. Amongst the additions were life size reconstructions of the flying reptile *Pteranodon* with a five metre wingspan, the dinosaur *Coelophysis* and a pair of ichthyosaurs.

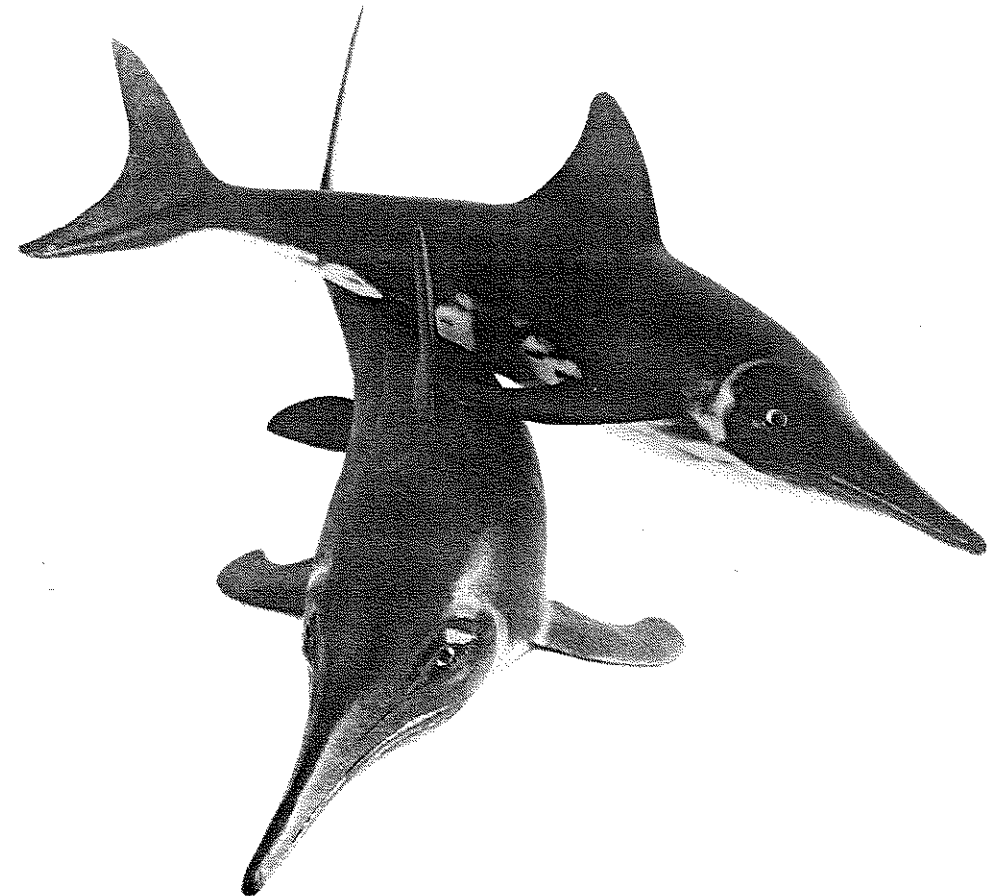
Supporting the exhibition were a number of special programmes. The planetarium show *Nemesis: The End of The Dinosaurs* dealt with possible causes of the dinosaurs' extinction. A new shop with a wide range of catalogues, books, posters, clothing and models was located near the exit to the exhibition. Within the exhibition itself the articulation and erection of the skeletons of the dinosaurs *Muttaburrasaurus* and *Deinonychus* was undertaken. The latter skeleton was being shown for the first time in Australia and was articulated by Robert Allen from the Peabody Museum, Yale, New Haven in Connecticut, United States of America.

The Education Section produced a series of educational programmes for children from pre-school to matriculation level. As part of this programme a kit on the exhibition was sent to each class before they visited the exhibition. The schedule of this education programme was completely booked within weeks of the exhibition opening. Following requests from schools throughout the state it proved possible to extend the exhibition for a further month.

Tasmanian Television generously sponsored the exhibition and provided an extensive advertising campaign on a statewide basis. *The Examiner* newspaper produced a special liftout educational supplement on the exhibition which was also distributed to schools.

More than 58,106 people visited the exhibition of which 10,000 were school children from throughout the state and the Bass Strait islands.

The generosity and enthusiasm of many people resulted in this exhibition being such a success. In particular the support of Dr Tom Rich, Mr Kevin Kelly and Mr Frank Coffa, of the Museum of Victoria, Dr Pat Rich, Monash University, and Mrs Marguerita Scott of *The Examiner* were particularly appreciated.



LAUNCESTON SCIENCE CENTRE

On 28th March the Premier of Tasmania, the Honourable Robin Gray, officially opened the Launceston Science Centre. Sponsored by BP Australia as a Bicentennial project this new branch of the Museum has been specially designed for children as an exciting 'hands-on' participatory introduction to the physical sciences.

A total of twenty-five interactive exhibitions allow visitors the opportunity to discover for themselves a variety of physical phenomena such as static electricity, sound waves and simple principles of mechanics in an everyday context.

An important element of the design of the exhibits

has been their modular nature so that the results of the continuing evaluation programme can be readily incorporated into the Centre. In addition it is planned that the exhibits will be changed regularly throughout the year.

A special education programme has been developed for both teachers and school groups. Since opening, the Centre has received an enthusiastic response from both school groups and the general public.

The Science Centre is open on weekends and available for schools and other booked groups by appointment during the week.